

Tip

Cable Organising

Inside your cabinet, or outside, organising your cables properly is essential. You can use plastic wire binders, or even rubber-bands, but make sure your cables are all arranged along the sides and the bottom. This prevents them from getting in the way of the airflow, and thus helps keep your cabinet cooler.

gained due to the cooler, we couldn't screw the drives in because the holes on the disks refused to line up with the holes on the cabinets. Our solution, although requiring considerable finger-acrobatics, was to screw the hard drives into their bays, sans coolers, and then attach the cooler from below. Basically, we attached the coolers from under the notches that the hard drives rest on! The pain was worth it, because we'd rather not risk our data on a hard drive that's clattering about inside a cabinet.

Placing the hard drive above or in front of the cabinet's front intake fan seemed to help. When we filled our cabinet with smoke again, we saw that the smoke around the disks disappeared even faster than before, and was all thrown out from the rear intake fan. We also noticed that after running a few games, the hard drives seemed a lot cooler than before, especially the Maxtor, which used to get so hot that you couldn't touch it without discomfort. After the hard drive cooler was added, though, it always seemed to stay cool!

Cabinet temperatures were not affected at all, though, by adding the hard drive fan. However, if you use your computer in a way that has a lot of hard drive usage, such as rendering, or even leaving it on all night downloading from P2P networks, a hard disk cooler is probably a good investment, and should help prolong the drive's life.

For The Adventurous

If you're not satisfied with just adding on another fan and a hard disk cooler, you can go out and get yourself some cutting equipment, and cut a hole into the top of your cabinet as well. We suggest that you do it above the RAM strips, or basically towards the end of your motherboard.

Make sure the fan is placed as an exhaust, and make sure that there is at least 6 inches of space between the top of the cabinet and your desk. This will help hot air that accumulates around the power supply—and the top of the cabinet in general—flow out easily. Besides, hot air rises, so the exhaust on top will make sure it rises out of the cabinet!

If you're one of the crazy people who want to attach a rather huge fan to the side of your cabinet, make sure all other fans are set as exhausts, including the front fan. This is because the smaller front fan will be no match for a huge fan, so it might as well help it send air out instead of opposing it by trying to send air in.

Do It Yourself

All this said, it's not enough for you to just read this article and nod in agreement with what we're saying (or in disagreement either). We'd



If you disconnect all the other fans and stick the incense close to the processor, you can watch the airflow around the area better—including how that air is sucked up by the power supply as well



It's advisable not to forget your smouldering incense in the cabinet while you go stuff your face

rather you discover the joys of tinkering with your PC. Remember, when playing with fire (or smoke), play it safe. And let us know if you come up with some ingenious ideas for improving the airflow / cooling of your PC.

Remember, we've shown you how to improve airflow using standard components. However, if you have powerful heat-generating components, like an overclocked CPU, a powerful graphics card, and a 500+ W power supply, the heat generated increases dramatically, and you will see greater differences after optimising airflow.

Also, watch this space for more such articles, and we promise you, they're about to get geekier! ☒

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